The University Of Queensland
AUSTRALIA
CREATE CHANGE

Studio 2 – Interaction Design DECO2850 / DECO7285

Week 9: User Enactment

Why are we doing this?

Steps:

1. Form a Team and Define a Project
   - No technology/app at this stage
2. Plan a study to investigate the problem further
   - E.g. “How do UQ’s International students manage their diet?”
     - Develop a suit of methods (interviews, observations, etc.) to find answer to the question
     - Engage with potential users and collect data
3. Analyse data and develop initial ideas for design
4. Develop prototype – Iteration 1
5. Engage with same users and trial/ evaluate/ assess the prototype
6. Develop final prototype – Iteration 2

Week	Topic	Studio Activity
1. 30/07/26	Introduction	Introduction to the Course, Class overview, organisation, assessments, and project selection. Design Exercise
2. 06/08/26	Team formation	Speed Dating / Project Management Studio: Project idea brainstorming
3. 13/08/26	Understanding People	Methods: Interviews, Ethnography, Object-based Methods, Online Ethnography, etc. Studio
4. 20/08/26	Ethics & Values	Ethics, Values and Technology Studio
5. 27/08/26	Data Analysis	Qualitative Data Analysis Activity: Data Analysis
6. 03/09/26	Prototyping & Interactions	Prototyping Methods, API & Tangibles Activity: Prototyping
7. 10/09/26	UX	User Experience Design Studio
8. 17/09/26	Assessment 2: Milestone 1	Design Exhibit 1
9 24/09/26	User Enactment	Wizard of Oz, Role Playing, Bodystorming, Simulated Environments Activity: User Enactment
Semester Break		
10. 08/10/26	Evaluation	Evaluation methods Studio
11. 15/10/26	Field Trials	Field trial methods Studio
12. 22/10/26	Prep for Exhibit	Studio
13. 29/10/26	Assessment 2: Milestone 2	Design Exhibit 2
14.	SWOT VAC	
15.	Assessment 2: Milestone 3 13/11/2026, 3pm Assessment 3: Interviews between 9/11/2026 to 13/11/	
16.	Assessment 4 [PG only]: 16/11/2026, 3pm	

Reminders

- Keep on making Design Journal entries
- In week 13, complete/fully-functional prototypes
  - You can use open-source applications, APIs (cite them)

- Next week is semester break.
- Marks for Assessment 2.1 released this morning.

Today’s Topic

- 10:00 to 10:30 | Assessment feedback
- 10:30 to 11:15 | Intro: User Enactment
- 11:15 to 13:50 | Activity on User Enactment

Outcome:

Be able to run use enactment studies for your projects.

Evaluation is about understanding…

[Future] Technology Use

Evaluation

There is always something lacking during early evaluation…

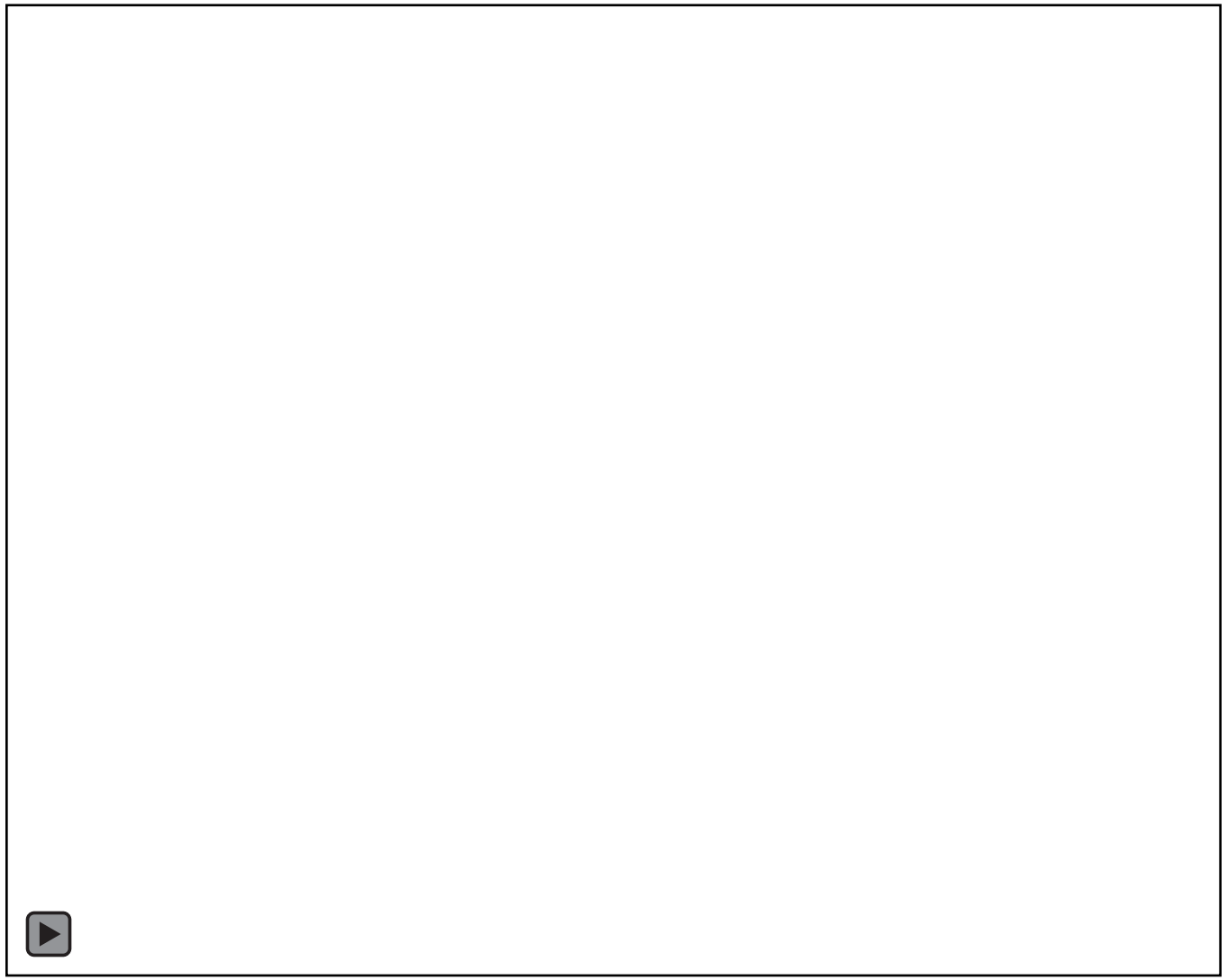
- Prototypes are ‘never’ 100% ready
- The context/setting may not be available
- Representative users are not available

User Enactment

Simulating **prototypes, settings** and/or **users** for understanding technology use and evaluating ideas

- As realistic as possible
- At least one or two aspects should be realistic
- Add props that help in simulation

User Enactment – Wizard of Oz



User Enactment – Wizard of Oz





Role-Playing and Bodystorming

- Participants (often design team members) act out specific scenario of prototype use; physically act out in a simulated environment
- Users' needs, goals and problems are identified;
- Better understanding of physical and spatial interactions (Homes, Offices,…) can be developed



https://www.servicedesignlab.net/



https://magazine.startus.cc/design-thinking-prototypes-to-roleplay/



When Role Playing is Not Enough: Improved Universal Design Education

Role-Playing and Bodystorming

- Let designers step into the shoes of users, simulating emotions, behaviours, and decision-making “in situ”
- Help designers understand, emotional and social dynamics
- Playful and engaging, encouraging creativity and group collaboration
- Quick identification of ergonomics issues; embodiment

- Strong commitment to empathy is required
- Role playing can exaggerate scenarios or miss real-world complexity

Role-Playing and Bodystorming



Experience prototyping
https://dl.acm.org/doi/abs/10.1145/347642.347802

Role-Playing and Bodystorming

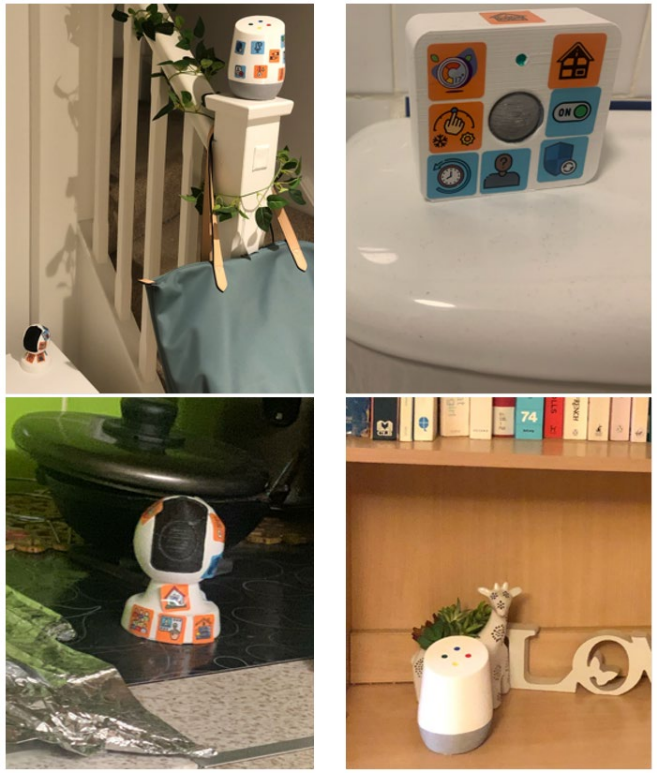


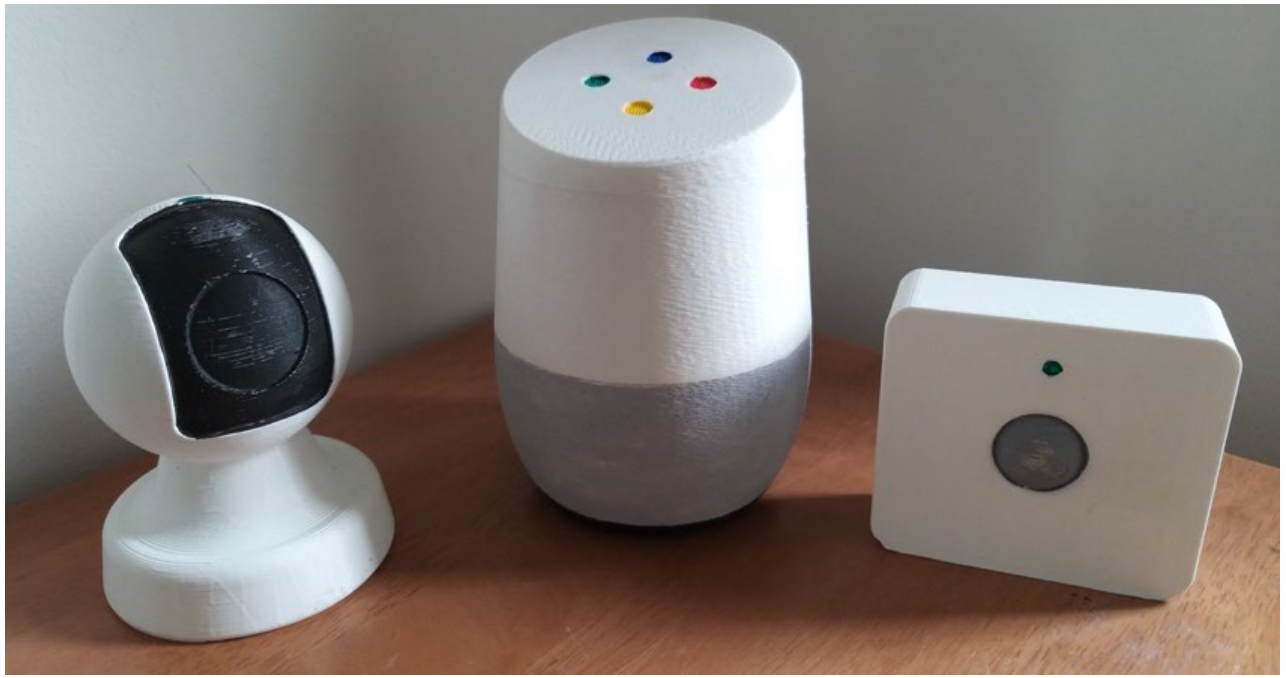
A fieldwork of the future with user enactments

https://dl.acm.org/doi/10.1145/2317956.2318008

Design Fiction Probes

Smart security devices in rental homes.





Laura Benton, Asimina Vasalou, and Sarah Turner. 2023. Location, Location, Security? Exploring Location-Based Smart Device Security Concerns and Mitigations within Low-Rent Homes. In Proceedings of the 2023 ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference (DIS '23). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 1060–1077. https://doi.org/10.1145/3563657.3596077

Activity: User Enactment

Develop a user enactment setup and gather feedback.

- Use the material provided here
- Use whiteboards and other resources

Deliverable: A set of design improvements

Activity: User Enactment

Develop a roleplay scenario and invite another team to experience your prototype.

- Step 1: Create a short brief of your project
  - In the form of: Who, What, Where, How and Why (just 1 line per topic)
- Step 2: Plan a user scenario – specific to your project
  - Add this to your design brief
- Step 3: Start building your user enactment setup using props and material
- Step 4: Develop a roleplay specific scenario

Develop a list of issues

Activity: User Enactment

3-4 members from another team will join your project

- Step 5: Select a team you want to have exchange with
- Step 6: Role play the given scenario (previous team must have left relevant info)
  - Teams to have define roles for their members
- Step 7: Observe and report issues, problems and future changes to your prototype
- Step 8: Discuss with the other team and share your insights


COFFEE
BREAK